THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 8: **The Sermon at Benares (First Flight)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The Buddha's response to Kisa Gotami is best described as: 1

(a) therapeutic **(b)** dismissive **(c)** argumentative **(d)** punitive

2. The story would lose effect if the Buddha: 1

(a) walked **(b)** told her directly
(c) wore a robe **(d)** stayed in Benares

3. Choose the correct conditional: 'If Kisa Gotami ___ one house without death, the Buddha's task would have been done.' 1

(a) finds **(b)** had found **(c)** found **(d)** has found

4. The author Betty Renshaw's narration of the sermon is a: 1

(a) retelling for modern readers **(b)** autobiography
(c) translation of a poem **(d)** biography

5. The story's central irony is that: 1

(a) the Buddha is poor
(b) the villagers are cruel
(c) the search for a death-free house shows death everywhere
(d) the seed is rare

6. Which sentence is an example of a metaphor? 1

(a) She asked questions. **(b)** Grief is an arrow lodged in the heart.
(c) Life is like a dream. **(d)** He walked slowly.

7. In 'Not a single house was free from death', the phrase 'Not a single' is used to: 1

(a) show doubt **(b)** stress that there was no exception
(c) give a command **(d)** ask a question

8. The impossibility of the task is intended to: 1

(a) make her angry **(b)** teach rather than to fail her
(c) punish her **(d)** test her speed

9. The tone of the Buddha's words is: 1

(a) harsh **(b)** funny
(c) nervous **(d)** gentle and authoritative

10. The expression 'a fair-weather friend' contrasts with the Buddha in that he: 1

(a) leaves in sorrow **(b)** laughs
(c) stays by the grieving **(d)** sells

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Explain the irony in Kisa Gotami's quest. 2

12. What is the function of images like the arrow and the ripe fruit? 2

13. How does the setting of Benares add significance? 2

14. How does the story use a concrete task to teach an abstract truth? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Critically examine the Buddha's method of consolation. 3

16. Compare Kisa Gotami's journey with Lencho's faith in 'A Letter to God' as responses to loss. 3

17. Rewrite using a participial phrase: 'Kisa Gotami was grieving. She wandered from house to house.' 3

OR

How does the structure of the lesson lead the reader from emotion to reflection? 3

18. How does the lesson present the relationship between teacher and learner? 3

OR

Identify and explain the figure of speech in 'pull out the arrow of grief'. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. 'The Sermon at Benares' teaches us to find peace through understanding rather than denial. Discuss. 5

OR

Write a reflective essay: 'What the mustard seed teaches us about loss'. 5

20. Write an analytical essay on the narrative and rhetorical techniques used in the lesson. 5

OR

Discuss the lesson's implicit social message about empathy. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND